



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

((Cyā ca śrutir* mokṣam avāptavanto* C)) |
((Cnṛ+pā* gr̥ha+sthā* iti na*etad* asti C)) |
((Cśama+pradhānaḥ kva ca mokṣa+dharmo* C)) |
((Cdaṇḍa+pradhānaḥ kva ca rāja+dharmāḥ C)) | 9.48 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 9, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Buddhacarita presents a powerful contrast, a pivotal moment in Siddhartha's journey as he grapples with the world's suffering and his own path to enlightenment. It speaks to the apparent contradiction between worldly duties and spiritual liberation, questioning whether one can truly attain freedom while still engaged in the responsibilities of a householder or a ruler. The verse highlights the perceived incompatibility between the pursuit of inner peace (śama-pradhānaḥ) and the dharma of liberation (mokṣa-dharmo), and the dharma of the king (rāja-dharmaḥ), which is characterized by the use of force (daṇḍa-pradhānaḥ). It suggests that the path to enlightenment seems separate from the demands of leadership and the attachments of family life.

However, a deeper understanding reveals a more nuanced perspective. While the verse initially emphasizes the divide, it also implicitly invites you to consider the possibility of integration. Can one find enlightenment within the world, rather than solely through renunciation? The key lies in understanding that true liberation is not about escaping responsibility, but about approaching it with wisdom and compassion. You can still be a loving parent, a responsible citizen, or even a leader, while simultaneously cultivating inner peace and striving for enlightenment.

In modern life, this translates to finding balance. You might feel torn between your career aspirations and your desire for a more meaningful existence. Perhaps you struggle to reconcile your personal values with the demands of your job or your social circles. The verse reminds you that it's possible to live authentically and ethically within the world, without sacrificing your spiritual growth. It encourages you to approach your responsibilities with mindfulness, integrity, and a commitment to alleviating suffering, both your own and that of others. The path isn't about choosing one over the other, but about finding a way to weave them together, transforming your daily life into a practice of awakening.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you integrate your spiritual aspirations with your worldly responsibilities to create a more harmonious and meaningful life?